

EXAMPLES OF PARENTAL CONTROL TOOLS

Software: Qustodio is a well-known parental control tool, offering comprehensive monitoring and control features. It lets you block websites and apps, restrict access to inappropriate content and time-wasting apps. Set screen time limits to manage the total device usage time and specific app usage duration. And most importantly, it tracks online activity, monitoring websites visited, apps used, and even YouTube watch history. Example: A parent can block social media apps during study hours while allowing educational websites.

Apps: Google Family Link is designed for managing children's Android devices and Chromebooks. It lets you set app permissions, approve or deny app installation requests and manage app permissions. Screen time management feature allows you to set daily device usage limits and bedtime schedules. Location tracking allows you to locate your child's device for added peace of mind. Example: Parents can prevent app downloads

outside of approved app stores and limit YouTube watch time before bedtime.

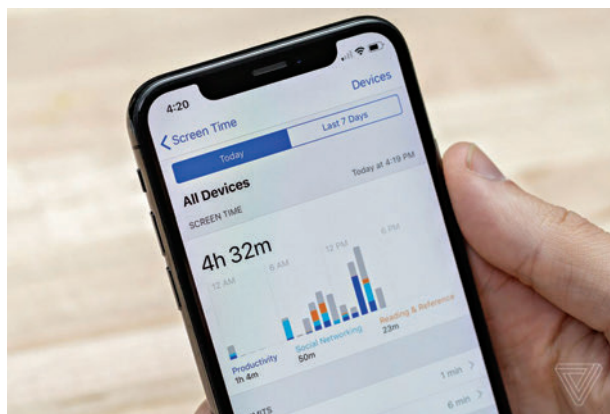
Devices: Apple ScreenTime (iOS/iPadOS) is a built-in feature on Apple devices. It allows for content restrictions that limits access to explicit content in iTunes, Safari, and other apps. Purchase restrictions require parental approval for app and in-app purchases. Parents can set mandatory downtime at specific times when the device is unavailable for entertainment purposes. Example: Parents can restrict access to mature-rated apps and movies while allowing educational apps to be used freely.

Additional Points: Many ISPs offer parental control tools that filter content at the network level. Popular consoles like PlayStation and Xbox have built-in parental control features to manage screen time, online interactions, and in-game purchases.

■ **Internet Service Providers (ISPs):** Many ISPs offer parental control options as part of their service. Check their website or contact customer support for guidance on activating these features.

On Devices:

- **Smartphones and Tablets:** Both Android and iOS devices have built-in parental controls.
 - For Android, open the Settings app, tap on Digital Well-being & parental controls, and set up Family Link for children under 13.
 - On iOS, go to Settings > Screen Time, and tap Continue. Choose "This is My Child's [device]" to set up Downtime, App Limits, and Content & Privacy with the necessary restrictions.



■ **Computers:** Windows and macOS both offer parental controls.

- **Windows:** Open Settings > Accounts > Family & other users. Add a child account and configure Windows Parental Controls.
- **macOS:** Go to System Preferences > Parental Controls. Create a managed account for your child and adjust settings as needed.

Choosing the Right Monitoring Tools

Beyond built-in options, numerous third-party parental control apps offer advanced features such as location tracking, app usage monitoring, and social media protection. When selecting a tool, it's important to consider:

- **Ease of Use:** The app should be straightforward to set up and manage.
- **Comprehensive Features:** Look for apps that provide the specific controls and monitoring capabilities you need, such as app blocking, web filtering, and time management.
- **Reputation and Reviews:** Research and read reviews to gauge the effectiveness and reliability of the app.

Implementing parental controls and utilising monitoring tools are vital steps in protecting children online. However, they should be part of a broader strategy that includes education and open communication. By understanding the online world together with your children, setting clear guidelines, and using the available technological tools, you can create a safer online environment that allows them to explore, learn, and connect in positive ways. **d**